A-A-20088
February 25, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SOUP MIXES, LOW-SODIUM, BEEF- AND CHICKEN-FLAVORED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

Salient characteristics.

Low-sodium beef- and low-sodium chicken-flavored soup mixes shall be formulated from combinations of dextrose, potassium chloride, onion, mono-ammonium glutamate, malto-dextrin, gelatin, autolyzed yeast, disodium inosinate or disodium guanylate. For beef-flavored soup mix, caramel color and beef flavor are added; while for chicken-flavored soup mix, chicken flavor, chicken fat and turmeric are added.

Finished product.

The finished product shall be uniformly blended, free flowing and possess a moisture content of not more than 2.5 percent. The finished product before reconstitution shall contain not more than 10 milligrams of sodium per 4 grams of product serving (6 fl oz).

The product must dissolve readily when stirred and be of sufficient strength to yield 6 ounces of soup when 4 grams of finished product is mixed with 6 ounces of boiling water. The prepared product shall have a good flavor and odor and shall be free from metal, wood, dirt, glass, paint, insects, and insect parts or any other foreign material.

Chemical analyses. Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the following Official Methods of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists:

Test	Sources		Method
Finished product			
Moisture	Chapter:	Fruits and Fruit Products	Moisture in dried fruits 1/
Sodium	Chapter:	Fish & Other Marine Products	Sodium and Potassium 2/ Official Final Action

1/ The pressure shall not exceed 50 mm of mercury during drying.

2/ Sodium may be analyzed using alternative methods such as Flame Photometry or Ion Selective Electrode method. In case of dispute as to test results, the test method cited above will govern.

FSC 8935
FSC 8940

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Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking (as appropriate and applicable).

The mixes shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurement.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. Commercial packaging. One pound, 4 ounces of product shall be packaged in a metal can, size 401 by 411, in accordance with commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. Twenty-four cans of product shall be packed in fiberboard containers complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of the fiberboard boxes. The cans shall be packed on end, 4 in length, 3 in width, and 2 in depth within the box. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad fabricated of the same material as the box.

C. Commercial unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type III, Class G of MIL-L-35078. For distribution to Navy, when unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

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D. Export packaging. One pound, 4 ounces of product shall be packaged in an open-top style, round metal can, size 401 by 411, with a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can body and ends shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate. The can shall have a sufficient base plate weight and temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The entire inside area of the can shall be enameled. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I or when specified, Type III of TT-C-495. The can shall be hermetically sealed.

E. Export packing. Twenty-four cans of product shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed on end, 4 in length, 3 in width, and 2 in depth within the box. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad fabricated of the same material as the box. For distribution to Navy, reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

F. Export unit loads. Shipping container shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type I, Class A of MIL-L-35078. For distribution to Navy, when unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

G. Labeling (commercial and export). Labeling of cans shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

H. Marking of shipping containers (commercial and export). Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable provided the following information is included:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Quantity, Unit of Issue
Date of Packaging (month/year)
Contract Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Inspection/Test Date

I. Marking of commercial and export unit loads. Commercial and export unit loads shall be marked on two adjacent sides with the following information:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Number of Containers per Load, Quantity per Container, Unit of Issue
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Date of Pack (month/year)
Inspection/Test Date

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Contract Number or Purchase Order Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Gross Weight (including pallet weight)
Cube

When the markings on one or more individual shipping containers are exposed on two adjacent sides of the unit load, a minimum 3- by 5-inch white label shall be applied on the same two adjacent sides of the load. The label shall be marked (letter size not less than 1/2 inch) with the following information:

Number of Containers per Load
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Gross Weight (including pallet weight)
Cube

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
1111 North 19th Street
Suite 210
Arlington, VA 22209

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. (This three-volume set may be purchased from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

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Civil agencies may obtain copies of this Commercial Item Description from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit request for copies to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this Commercial Item Description may be submitted to U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories; ATTN: DRDNA-ES; Natick, MA 01760.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
DOT - CGS
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FQA
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8935-0081

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